Corpus Linguistics

Reading argument 5

Name: _____ ID: _____

Question 1 Prediction

The "weak version" of the transfer account claims that L1 transfer is one of the causes of "passive" unaccusative errors (e.g., *Three boys were arrived*). Look at the following data. Each figure shows the percentage of "passive" unaccusatives among the non-target tokens (excluding the target-like NP–V pattern) in each L1 group. Explain why this table is **unexpected** from the viewpoint of the transfer account.

L1 group	**"Passive" unaccusatives / all non-target tokens**
Italian	8 / 22 (36.4%)
Korean	8 / 10 (80%)
Japanese	17 / 24 (70.8%)

Question 2 Corpus Search

Visit KeioSFC (https://keiosfc-aki2025.github.io/KeioSFC/keioSFC.html). Using X-search, find one instance of passivized unaccusatives. Copy and paste it in the designated space below.

Question 3 Reasoning

In Section IV-2, the author gives examples such as "…they were happened a few days ago…" and "…terrorism is happened very often…". Why are these examples important for evaluating the adjectival passive account?

① They show that learners use adverbials incorrectly, thereby corroborating the L1 transfer analysis.
② They show that the learners are describing dynamic events, not states, so the participles are unlikely to be adjectives.
③ They show that learners confuse *happen* with transitive verbs, suggesting that intransitive predicates are harder to acquire.
④ They show that Korean and Japanese learners make more errors than Italian learners, illustrating the importance of language variation.

Question 4 Explanation and synthesis

(a) One token in the data was "…this kind of problem will be exist forever…". In 2–3 sentences, explain why this example is a problem for the adjectival passive account. Use the word "redundant" or "stative" in your answer.

(b) Both Part 1 and Part 2 reject an explanation by checking it against corpus data. In one sentence, describe the shared reasoning: what does each account predict, and what did the data actually show?